



FREE PLAYBOOK · FOR REALTORS, 1099S & THE SELF-EMPLOYED

The Nevada Self-Employed Health Coverage Playbook

The five doors to real coverage when nobody hands you a benefits packet, the math that separates cheap plans from smart ones, and the six questions that make you impossible to oversell.



START HERE

Nobody hands you a benefits packet. Good.

When you work for yourself, health coverage is not a checkbox in an HR portal. It is a strategy decision, and self-employed Nevadans actually have more paths to coverage than employees do. Almost nobody explains those paths. That is what this playbook is for.

ProtectHealth is a Las Vegas brokerage built on one line: **the product should serve the strategy, not become the strategy**. Most agents open with a plan brochure. This playbook opens with how your business is actually built, because a sole proprietor, an LLC, and an S-corp can unlock different doors to coverage, and the right answer starts there.

How to use this playbook: read pages 3 and 4 to learn the two pieces of math that decide everything. Read page 5 to see all five doors. Use page 8 as your armor in any sales conversation, including one with us. Twenty minutes of reading, and you will know more than most people who have carried coverage for a decade.

What's inside

- ✓ **The four numbers that actually matter** and the one-line worst-case formula
- ✓ **The metal tier system decoded** with the chart carriers rarely show you
- ✓ **All five coverage doors** for the self-employed, side by side
- ✓ **The Nevada numbers** on Realtors, 1099s, and the structures growing fastest
- ✓ **Every enrollment window** so a date never costs you a year of coverage
- ✓ **Six questions** that make any agent show their hand

LESSON ONE

The four numbers that **actually** matter

Health plans are marketed on one number, the monthly premium. The real cost of a plan lives in four. Learn these and every plan comparison for the rest of your life gets easier.

Number	What it really means
Premium	The only cost you pay for certain, every month, care or no care.
Deductible	What you pay out of pocket before most benefits start. Due in full when care happens.
Coinsurance	Your percentage share of bills after the deductible, commonly 20 to 40 percent.
Out-of-pocket maximum	The ceiling. The most a covered year can cost you. The single most protective number on the page.

The worst-case formula: $\text{Premium} \times 12 + \text{Out-of-pocket maximum} = \text{the real worst case}$. Compare every plan on this total, not the sticker. Two plans with identical premiums can carry ceilings thousands of dollars apart, and the plan documents will not point that out for you.

Same premium, very different years

Illustrative example: two \$450/month plans in a bad year (one hospital admission)

Plan A total		\$12,400
Plan B total		\$16,800

Identical monthly cost. A \$4,400 difference the sticker never showed. That gap is the out-of-pocket maximum doing its work.

Commission income tip: your worst-case number matters even more when income swings month to month. A ceiling you could not write a check for is not a plan, it is a hope.

LESSON TWO

Metal tiers, decoded

Every Nevada marketplace plan wears a metal name. The metals describe cost sharing, not quality of care. Lower metal means lower premium and more of the bill on you when care happens. By law, each tier is designed to cover a set share of the average member's costs:

How much of average medical costs each tier is designed to cover

Actuarial value targets set by the Affordable Care Act



Bronze tends to fit

Healthy years, strong cash cushion, premium savings deliberately banked against the higher ceiling. It is a legitimate strategy when it is chosen, not defaulted into.

Silver's quiet superpower

At certain income levels, cost-sharing reductions supercharge Silver plans only. Households that qualify often get Gold-like protection at Silver prices. This is the most missed deal in Nevada health insurance.

Gold and Platinum tend to fit

Regular prescriptions, ongoing care, planned procedures, or simply a strong preference for predictable costs over premium savings.

Subsidy check first, always. Premium tax credits reach further up the income scale than most self-employed people assume, and they only apply through Nevada Health Link, the state's official marketplace. Checking eligibility costs nothing and regularly changes the whole decision.

THE MAP

Five doors to coverage when you're the boss

Most self-employed Nevadans only ever hear about door one. Your business structure decides which of the others can open, which is why the conversation should start with how you are set up, not with a plan brochure.

Door	How it works	Tends to fit
1. Marketplace + tax credits	Individual plan through Nevada Health Link, premium lowered by income-based credits, reconciled at tax time.	Most 1099s and solo operators, especially at moderate incomes
2. Spouse's plan	Join a spouse's employer coverage. Often the cheapest door when it exists, worth pricing honestly against door one.	Married, spouse has strong W-2 benefits
3. ICHRA	A structure where a business reimburses individual health premiums with pre-tax dollars, growing fast nationwide.	Owners with employees, some owner arrangements by entity type
4. Section 105 / QSEHRA	Reimbursement arrangements that can turn qualifying medical costs into business expenses in specific setups.	Specific entity structures, sometimes a hired spouse
5. Keep what you have	Sometimes the current setup is already right, and the honest answer is to change nothing.	Anyone. Hearing this from an advisor is a good sign.

The honesty clause: not every self-employed person qualifies for doors three and four. Eligibility depends on business structure, income, and household detail, which is exactly why the strategy conversation exists. Anyone who promises every 1099 a tax-advantaged structure before learning how the business is built is selling, not advising.

Tax note: ProtectHealth brokers are insurance nerds, not tax professionals. Doors three and four always deserve a quick confirmation with a licensed tax professional, and a good broker will say so unprompted.

THE NUMBERS

What the data says about people like you

1 in 7

Realtors still carry no health coverage at all, not because options don't exist, but because nobody explained them.

Source: National Association of Realtors member data

~5M

Small-business owners and self-employed Americans enrolled through the ACA marketplace in 2025.

Source: Center on Budget and Policy Priorities

+52%

Year-over-year growth in ICHRA adoption among small employers, the fifth straight year of growth.

Source: HRA Council 2025 Data Report

83%

Of employers offering ICHRA or QSEHRA in 2025 had never offered coverage before. The structures are opening new doors.

Source: HRA Council 2025 Data Report

ICHRA adoption is compounding

Year-over-year growth by employer size, 2025 reporting



The takeaway is not that any one product is the answer. It is that the menu is changing fast, and self-employed Nevadans deciding from a five-year-old mental menu are usually leaving either money or protection on the table.

THE CALENDAR

Timing is part of the coverage

Missing a window is the one insurance mistake money cannot fix afterward. There are only three dates a self-employed Nevadan needs to respect:

Window	The rule
November 1 – January 15	Nevada open enrollment. The one stretch every year when anyone can enroll in or switch marketplace coverage, through Nevada Health Link.
60 days after a life event	Losing other coverage, moving, marriage, a new child, and similar qualifying events open a special enrollment window. It closes fast and does not reopen.
Year-round	The strategy conversation. Reviewing structure, checking subsidy eligibility, and pressure-testing your current plan need no window at all.

The auto-renewal trap: letting a plan quietly roll over each January feels safe and regularly is not. Las Vegas networks reshuffle every year, drug lists change, and the plan that fit two years ago can orphan your doctor without you changing anything. One review each fall, fifteen minutes, prevents all of it.

Your pre-enrollment checklist

- ☐ Rough household income estimate for next year (subsidies key off this)
- ☐ List of doctors that matter to your household, checked against any plan you consider
- ☐ Current prescription list with dosages
- ☐ Your business structure: sole proprietor, LLC, or S-corp
- ☐ Last year's total health spending, premiums plus out-of-pocket, as your baseline

YOUR ARMOR

Six questions that make any agent show their hand

Bring these to every insurance conversation you ever have, including one with ProtectHealth. Direct answers to all six make you nearly impossible to oversell. Evasive answers are the signal to leave.

#	Ask this	A good answer sounds like
1	How do you get paid?	Plainly stated. Carrier commissions at identical consumer pricing is the honest norm.
2	What does this plan not cover?	Specifics, immediately, without checking notes.
3	What does my worst-case year cost on this plan?	One number: premium times twelve plus the out-of-pocket maximum.
4	Are my doctors in this exact plan's network?	Checked live, against the specific plan ID, not the brand name.
5	Did you check my subsidy eligibility?	Yes, with your income estimate, before quoting anything.
6	Does my business structure change my options?	Real questions about your entity type, plus a recommendation to confirm tax angles with a tax professional.

Red flags, for balance: quoting before asking about doctors and medications. Promising a tax-advantaged structure before learning your entity type. Any pressure to decide today. Enrollment windows create real deadlines, salespeople create fake ones.



YOUR NEXT 20 MINUTES

You now know more than most people who've carried coverage for a decade.

Want the map for your life?

One free 20-minute conversation. You bring how your business is actually built. A ProtectHealth broker maps which of the five doors open for you, which don't, and what your real worst-case number is. No pitch, no pressure, no 40-slide deck. If what you already have is right, that is exactly what you will hear.

Book at protecthealth.com/self-employed

Or call **800-240-8185** · 2915 W Charleston Blvd Ste 170, Las Vegas

★★★★★ 4.9 from 703+ Google reviews, from people who had this exact conversation.

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